

## Delaware County Drainage Board, Dec. 10th 2025

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RRz-6UUVTQ8">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RRz-6UUVTQ8</a> |
| Publication Date | 2025-12-11T02:46:08Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Drainage Board Meeting Summary

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Drainage Board to order.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Mr. White (Whitehead), Mr. Christie, Mr. Buckle, Mr. Hamilton, Ms. Rian (noted during roll calls).
  - **Members Absent:** Mr. Wisley (noted absent during initial roll call).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in opening transcript, but leading procedural actions.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:02](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:00:27](#) The minutes of the November 12th meeting were approved.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 5-0 by roll call vote.

## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:14:27 Hearing on Honey Creek / Hog Creek Reconstruction**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The Surveyor presented a petition for reconstruction on a newly accepted small ditch/drain (originating from a petition by Dale Connor). Because the ditch was previously in the road right-of-way, it could not be worked on; now designated as a regulated drain, the board considered moving forward with reconstruction, which may extend up to Hog Creek depending on engineering surveys. Landowner support was confirmed.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** 00:15:47 Mr. Jim Swingley spoke as a taxpayer regarding Hog Creek, noting that it had not been dredged since 1946 or 1948 and discussing the historical scope from south of Centennial.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to move forward with reconstruction approved 5-0 by roll call vote 00:18:12.
- **00:18:30 Engineering Contract: Loch Mueller Engineering for Hog Creek Project**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Surveyor & Board Members (mentioning a Zoom call with Anthony Goodnight and Angie Moyer).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding hiring Loch Mueller Engineering to provide services for the reconstruction project. A blanket contract would authorize them to begin work, and they will present a formal proposal and service estimate at the next drainage board meeting.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to hire Loch Mueller Engineering approved by roll call vote (recorded as passing) 00:19:45.
- **00:20:05 Request for Ferguson Drain Tie-In (Earthworks Land Services)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Rick Wood (Earthworks Land Services).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Rick Wood requested permission to tie a 6-inch perimeter drain into the Ferguson Drain (or potentially a farmer's private tile first) for a small (~1 acre) project with a new septic. The Surveyor provided a favorable recommendation, noting it is a small tile discharging into a wide-open ditch with a clean-out and varmint guard. Legal counsel noted no objections.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote 00:22:11.
- **00:22:28 Studebaker Drain Tie-In (Brian Winter / Walnut & 800 North)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Mr. Hamilton.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Brian Winter requested to tie a 15-inch drain into the existing 18-inch regulated drain (crib number six of Studebaker) to drain approximately 150 acres (~2 million gallons/day). The Surveyor noted no objections and stated he plans to check and fix two small sinkholes on the county main once snow melts.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote 00:23:48.

## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **00:01:06 Cheryl Dawson** (4214 West State Road 28)
  - Addressed the board regarding Kilbuck Creek running through her organic family farm. She reported that she and her farm helpers spent 9 days and over \$2,000 cleaning a section of the ditch from west to east (removing fallen trees and invasive honeysuckle while preserving desirable trees, bank stability, and wildlife habitat). She requested assurance that her organic farm section is not scheduled for destructive mechanical excavator debrushing. The Surveyor acknowledged she is maintaining it effectively and privately.
- **00:10:31 Jim Swingley**
  - Addressed the board noting hearing and visibility limitations, asking for clarification on the previous speaker's testimony regarding Kilbuck Creek and expressing concerns about audio amplification in the meeting room.
- **00:24:24 Max Hayden** (11250 South Honey Creek Road, Daleville)
  - Requested that Walter's Creek (near 700 South and 400) be dredged, noting that the creek has severe bank erosion, large fallen trees, and is failing to drain local agricultural ditches.

## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **Old Business / Commercial Development:** The Surveyor reported on a parcel near John Deere / old Kmart (inquiring about regulated drains), noting no regulated drains exist there, only private tiles. The board discussed coordinating developer awareness and potential mutual tile agreements.
  - **Debrushing List:** The Surveyor presented an initial start list of debrushing jobs across the county to build up annual maintenance programs. Additional sites (such as No Name Creek under the A. McConnell project and Tom Spangler's complaint on the Edward Ree 203 ditch) were discussed for priority addition.
  - **New Housing Subdivision (Jackson & Morrison):** Commissioner Steven Bran and the Surveyor provided updates on a newly approved residential subdivision featuring three retention ponds and wetland preservation designed to manage discharge into Hyatt/York Prairie Creek and alleviate local drainage bottlenecks.
  - **Legal Counsel Update:** Mention of potential future consideration of the law firm Brook and Strugal as legal counsel for the drainage board.
- **Maintenance Claims:**
  - Discussed claims including work by Tim Holless (sinkhole repair) and Cody Light's drainage concerns.
  - Discussed a 20% retainage withheld on a JJC invoice regarding the Racer Ditch pending final site cleanup (removing school-bus-sized stick piles).

- **Action:** Maintenance claims approved as presented by roll call vote 00:41:37.
  - **Adjournment:**
    - The presiding officer wished everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.
    - **Disposition:** Approved by unanimous voice vote (I) 00:42:04.
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